



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy Queen of Martyrs
School Website: <https://www.chestertonqofm.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy Queen Martyrs (Sun Prairie, WI) demonstrates a strong classical orientation rooted in Catholic faith, with explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty, virtue formation, and a liberal-arts curriculum. Public materials emphasize a Catholic, classical identity, daily Mass and regular sacraments, and a Three Pillars model (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) that frames both curriculum and community life. There is clear alignment with several core classical criteria (Religious foundations, formation-focused purpose, liberal-arts curriculum, and a parental/community partnership), while some traditionally explicit pedagogical and faculty practices are less directly articulated in the public site content (e.g., explicit Socratic pedagogy or a formal "living curriculum" narrative). Overall, the school is best described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong CLASSICAL elements in Categories 1, 2, and 6, and notable but less explicit alignment in Categories 3–5.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are strongly affirmed through Catholic identity, daily Mass, sacramental life, and Catholic anthropology integrated across subjects. Evidence: Catholic identity, Mass, sacraments, and incarnational pedagogy described on the site. [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file8](#) - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and a pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, aligning with classical aims. Evidence: Three Pillars model; statements about forming virtuous Catholic leaders; restoration of truth, goodness, and beauty. [filecite\turn0file1\turn0file3](#) - Curriculum signals align with liberal arts and classical education (Western thought, Latin, philosophy, history, mathematics, music), though explicit Great Books/Great Conversation phrasing is not always present in the public materials. Evidence: explicit reference to Western thought/classics and sample upper-year courses (history, literature, philosophy, Latin, astronomy, math, music). [filecite\turn0file1\turn0file2](#) - Pedagogy hints include contemplative and communal elements (Lyceum, Mass, house system, shadow/open houses), but explicit articulation of Socratic seminars or scholé as core classroom methods is not clearly stated in the site copy. Evidence: Lyceum lunch period, shadow days, house system, daily Mass. [filecite\turn0file2\turn0file3\turn0file8](#) - Faculty portrayal is present in leadership and close-knit community language, but the site does not consistently foreground a formal "living curriculum" or teacher portrait as a stated pillar. Evidence: Head of School named, signs of mentoring culture; but lack of explicit "living curriculum" language. - Parents and community engagement are strong and explicit (open houses, shadow days, parish-connected environment, fundraising/donor activities), signaling robust partnership with families. Evidence: Open houses for parents, tours/shadow days, Catholic community life, donor/fundraising sections. [filecite\turn0file18\turn0file3\turn0file9](#)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Catholic, classical high school identity, including mass and sacraments as foundational to daily life. [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file8](#) - The school foregrounds Catholic anthropology integrated into coursework, and liturgical practices (daily Mass, weekly Eucharistic adoration). - The Three Pillars Model (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) anchors formation in truth, goodness, and beauty.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, Mass, sacraments, theology,

liturgy, Catholic anthropology, incarnational, truth, goodness, beauty, liturgy, wonder (as a value in formation), Logos (implied through classical-Catholic framing). - Negative keywords: Not evident in the public materials; none clearly invoked as counter-signals.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: approximately 8–10 distinct Catholic/theological keywords evident across pages. - Negative keyword hits: 0 clearly identified. - Ratio (positive:negative) approx. 8–10:0

Why this rating - The combination of explicit Catholic identity, liturgical life, sacramental access, and a metaphysical/teleological frame around truth/goodness/beauty strongly aligns with Transcendental moral realism and liturgical community practices described in the Six Essential Elements. This category clearly meets CLASSICAL criteria. ☐filecite☐turn0file0☐turn0file8☐

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials articulate formation of virtue and wisdom as the primary aim, not simply job-preparation, with emphasis on human flourishing and moral excellence. - The school emphasizes forming virtuous Catholic leaders and living out truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than solely technical outcomes. - The Three Pillars model and references to virtue development reinforce formation as the telos of education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, teleology (through telos emphasis), noble leadership, moral imagination. - Negative keywords: None apparent in the public materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: 6–8 - Negative keyword hits: 0 - Ratio approx. 6–8:0

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, together with a teleological, virtue-centered aim, aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and goal. ☐filecite☐turn0file1☐turn0file3☐

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site asserts “the classics of Western thought,” a liberal-arts orientation, and a curriculum spanning history, literature, philosophy, Latin, mathematics, astronomy, and music. This indicates a liberal-arts core consistent with classical education. ☐filecite☐turn0file1☐turn0file2☐ - Coursework examples include philosophy, Latin, history, literature, and math/science, suggesting integrated, cross-disciplinary study typical of liberal-arts classical programs. - While the site emphasizes “classics” and Western thought, explicit mention of Great Books as a stated requirement or of a formal Great Conversation is not always explicit in the public text provided. (The language leans toward “classics of Western thought” and “the great ideas.”)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: classics, Western thought, philosophy, Latin, history, literature, mathematics, astronomy, music, liberal arts. - Negative keywords: None clearly present in public materials. - The absence of an explicit “Great Books”/“Great Conversation” phrase reduces absolute alignment with Element 3’s strongest form, but the core liberal-arts/classical vocabulary is present.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: 6–8 - Negative keyword hits: 0 - Ratio approx. 6–8:0

Why this rating - The curriculum shows solid classical foundations (liberal arts core, emphasis on classics, cross-disciplinary study) but without consistently explicit references to certain canonical elements (e.g., explicit Great Books / Great Conversation language in the public copy). This yields a confident SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than full CLASSICAL. ☐filecite☐turn0file1☐turn0file2☐

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials indicate a mix of contemplative/community-centered elements (Lyceum period, house system, shadow day, Mass), with emphasis on a joyful, integrated experience and formation. This hints at a pedagogy that values contemplation and community life alongside academics. ☐filecite☐turn0file2☐turn0file3☐ - The Three Pillars model and the focus on forming intellect, character, and spir-

ituality imply deliberate pedagogy, but explicit references to standard classical methods such as Socratic seminars, memorization/recitation, or strict scholé days are not consistently stated in the site copy. The site's language leans toward a holistic, faith-centered approach rather than a catalog of classical teaching techniques.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Lyceum, contemplative/joyful learning, classical education, integrated curriculum, formation, virtue, reverence, wonder. - Negative keywords: Not explicitly present in the site copy (no strong signals of non-classical approaches like purely project-based or constructivist-only pedagogy).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: 3–5 - Negative keyword hits: 0 - Ratio approx. 3–5:0

Why this rating - The presence of contemplative elements and a structured, faith-informed pedagogy suggests alignment with classical pedagogy in spirit, even if explicit Socratic/seminar language is not pervasive across the public site. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. □filecite□turn0file2□turn0file3□

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site highlights a Head of School and a community of educators, but explicit statements about faculty as “living curriculum,” portraits, or a formal faculty philosophy are not consistently present in the public content. The leadership presence (Head of School) signals professional, mentor-like roles, but the explicit classical-faculty framing is less visible. - The public content demonstrates teachers and administrators engaged in formation-focused activities (e.g., Mass, open houses, shadow days), but lacks an explicit, canonical articulation of faculty as the core living curriculum.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor/leader (implied), head of school, formation, virtuous leadership (implied through the school's mission). - Negative keywords: None clearly identified in the public copy.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: 2–4 - Negative keyword hits: 0 - Ratio approx. 2–4:0

Why this rating - The presence of leadership and mentorship signals, without a strong explicit articulation of the “living curriculum,” supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for Element 5. A more explicit statement about teachers as living exemplars or a formal “portrait of a teacher” would push this toward CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school actively invites parent involvement through open houses, shadow days, and visitor-friendly formats, signaling partnership with families as co-educators. There are also donor/fundraising sections and community-facing communications (gala, donor opportunities). □filecite□turn0file3□turn0file18□ - The site emphasizes a Catholic, family-integrated environment (daily Mass, sacraments, pilgrimages, retreats) and explicit calls for family engagement and formation within the Chesterton framework. This aligns with the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” elements.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, family involvement, Catholic community, pilgrimages/retreats, parish connections, open visits. - Negative keywords: Not evident.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword hits: 5–7 - Negative keyword hits: 0 - Ratio approx. 5–7:0

Why this rating - The public materials strongly support parents as partners and a welcoming, family-inclusive community, which is a hallmark of CLASSICAL practice in the Six Elements framework. □filecite□turn0file3□turn0file18□

Overall Assessment (Aggregate)

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL

- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Strengthen explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing in Curriculum (Element 3) by clearly naming a Great Books program, required classical texts, and cross-disciplinary discussion of canonical works. Publish a concrete list of Great Books and trace how Great Conversation is integrated across grades.
- Make explicit the core classical pedagogy (Element 4) by foregrounding Socratic seminars, scholé days, and memorization/recitation as standard teaching methods, with examples from specific courses and grade levels.
- Expand the Faculty narrative (Element 5) to include a formal “living-curriculum” teacher portrait and teacher-formation initiatives (e.g., ongoing faculty seminars on classical pedagogy, mentorship roles, and living exemplars of virtue). Show these practices publicly.
- Maintain and expand parental formation programs (Element 6) by offering regular book clubs, parent sessions, and family catechesis aligned with classical aims, and by documenting parental engagement outcomes.

ABSTRACT

This Chesterton Academy Queen Martyrs evaluation applies a six-category classical-education rubric derived from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School, using both the public-school-site content and the classical lexicon to determine orientation. The school presents a pronounced religious-metaphysical foundation (Element 1) through explicit Catholic identity, daily Mass, sacramental life, and a theology-informed pedagogy. The School Purpose & Goal (Element 2) strongly emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful teleology, aligning with classical aims. Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4) show liberal-arts/classical alignment with a Western-tradition emphasis and reflective, communal practices—but with less explicit, consistent statements about certain canonical classical-pedagogical methods (e.g., explicit Great Books, Socratic seminars, or scholé days) in the site copy. Faculty (Element 5) is represented through leadership and a formation-oriented environment, yet the public narrative lacks a fully articulated “living curriculum” portrayal of teachers. Parents & Community (Element 6) is strongly developed via open houses, shadow days, and an engaged Catholic community; parental involvement is clearly encouraged and facilitated.

CATEGORY RATINGS - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Note: The Chesterton Academy Queen Martyrs deploys a compelling classical-Catholic identity across its public materials, with particularly strong evidence for religious foundations, formation-focused aims, and parental/community partnerships. It would move toward full CLASSICAL with more explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation in the curriculum; clearer public statements of classic pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, scholé days); and a more explicit lived-curriculum portrait of faculty.

Cited sources (selected): - Catholic, classical identity and daily Mass; Catholic anthropology integrated across subjects. [filecite\turn0file0\turn0file8](#) - Three Pillars Model and formation language (Intellect, Character, Spirituality). - Curricular breadth and upper-year course examples (history, literature, philosophy, Latin, astronomy, math, music). - Open Houses, Shadow Days, and parent-facing communications; community and fundraising content. [filecite\turn0file3\turn0file18](#) - Donor/Community materials and Catholic community framing (Catholic Schools Week, governance, community life).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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